SteerHealth

Checklist

Smart Capacity starts with *Smart Readiness*

Use this ASC checklist to automate each presurgical milestone — T-21, T-14, T-7, DOS — and eliminate last-minute cancellations, delays, and revenue leaks

Prime Healthcare

Neurology Associates of Texas

ORANGE COUNTY NEUROSURGICAL ASSOCIATES

OrthoWest

SHORELINE SURGERY CENTER



T-21 (Three Weeks Out): Initiate & Inform

- [ ] Import & classify scheduled cases (procedure, surgeon, payor, risk tier)
- [ ] Kick off benefits verification and pre-authorization prep (as needed)
- [ ] Identity verification & demographics confirmed (phone/email/mobile)
- [ ] Digital intake and e-consents sent to patient
- [ ] Medical history & comorbidity screening complete
- [ ] Medication review: flag GLP-1, SGLT2, anticoagulants, ACEi/ARB per policy
- [ ] Pre-op orders placed per protocol (labs, EKG, imaging as indicated)
- [ ] External specialist clearance(s) requested, if indicated (e.g., cardiology)
- [ ] Personalized prep plan delivered (fasting, skin prep, device/implant notes)
- [ ] Financial estimate delivered; deposits/pre-pay options offered
- [ ] Transportation & caregiver plan documented; interpreter needs captured
- [ ] Patient communications channel(s) confirmed (SMS/voice/email)

T-14 (Two Weeks Out): Execute PAT & Confirm

- [ ] PAT protocol execution in progress; role-based tasks assigned (RN/NP/Anes)
- [ ] Benefits verification updated; authorization submitted/tracked (if required)
- [ ] Medication adjustments communicated per policy (e.g., GLP-1 hold)
- [ ] Labs, EKG, imaging scheduled/completed; results routed to chart
- [ ] Specialist clearances received; documentation attached to chart
- [ ] NPO and medication guidance reinforced (multilingual as needed)
- [ ] Pre-payment follow-up sent; payment plan documented if applicable
- [ ] Eligibility re-check performed for any payor changes
- [ ] Social factors reviewed (transport, caregiver, home setup)
- [ ] Patient confirms contactability and readiness status

T-7 (One Week Out): Readiness Sweep & Backup Plan

- [ ] Final readiness sweep: missing items auto-escalated to owner
- [ ] Authorization status green; exceptions escalated to financial counseling
- [ ] All labs/clearances present; anesthesia review complete
- [ ] Arrival window, directions, parking, and check-in instructions sent
- [ ] Medication/NPO reconfirmed via quick-reply ("I'm ready" / "Need help")
- [ ] Backup-case pool prepared for potential short-notice cancellations
- [ ] Patients at high no-show risk flagged for proactive outreach
- [ ] Chart completeness audit: consents, orders, documents present

DOS-1 & DOS Execute Day-Of Playbook

- [ ] NPO and medication adherence confirmed
- [ ] Chart check: labs/imaging/clearances present; consents signed
- [ ] Real-time readiness board active for front desk, nursing, anesthesia
- [ ] If cancellation occurs: backfill protocol triggered from ready pool
- [ ] Turnover and on-time start tracking in place (live dashboard)
- [ ] Post-op instructions queued; patient/caregiver contacts verified

Revenue Readiness & Financial Workflows

- [ ] Benefits verified; coverage details documented in chart
- [ ] Authorization submitted/approved; reference numbers logged
- [ ] Accurate estimate delivered; financial policy communicated
- [ ] Pre-payment/deposit collected or plan arranged
- [ ] Coordination for implants/devices and vendor paperwork completed

Revenue Readiness & Financial Workflows

- [ ] **ABN or equivalent documentation handled where applicable**

Capacity & Scheduling Optimization

- [ ] **Scheduling with Waitlist/backfill workflow active with eligible cases**
- [ ] **Block optimization rules defined (swap thresholds, lead-time triggers)**
- [ ] **Eligible same-day add-ons identified with staffing checks**
- [ ] **Surgeon preference cards validated and stocked for target cases**

Patient Communications & Experience

- [ ] **Multichannel outreach enabled (SMS/voice/email); fallback voice available**
- [ ] **Multilingual materials available; interpreter services scheduled if needed**
- [ ] **Two-way messaging enabled; common questions routed and answered**
- [ ] **Micro-education delivered (short, procedure-specific content)**
- [ ] **Accessibility considerations documented (hearing/vision/cognitive)**

Compliance, Privacy & Audit

- [ ] **HIPAA & SOC 2 controls observed; BAA in place with vendors**
- [ ] **Access controls and audit trails enabled for all pre-op workflows**
- [ ] **Clinical protocols approved by medical leadership and reviewed periodically**
- [ ] **Document retention and deletion policies configured**

Measurement & Continuous Improvement

- [ ] Clean-room style measurement plan defined
- [ ] Cancellation avoidance (# and %) vs. baseline
- [ ] On-time first-case starts (%)
- [ ] Lead time to readiness (days)
- [ ] Pre-op phone volume reduction (#)
- [ ] Pre-payment capture rate (%)

Throughput (cases/day) and block utilization (%)

- [ ] Weekly review cadence set; owners and SLAs defined
- [ ] Root-cause analysis template prepared for exceptions
- [ ] Quarterly protocol optimization (update PAT rules, education, alerts)



Predictable Surgeries: *On time. All the Time*

Steer Health's Intelligent & Adaptive Layer orchestrates every step of the presurgical journey—T-21, T-14, T-7, PAT—so your cases arrive ready, starts run on time, and staff are freed from phone-tag and paperwork.

Smart Capacity. Stronger Margins.

Get a 20-minute demo ↗

Still exploring?

See how leaders from Prime Healthcare are using Steer's Smart Capacity platform to drive higher utilization and smarter margins.

Speakers featured in the session:

Sunil Patel, MD
Regional Chief Medical Officer
Prime Healthcare



Farzad Massoudi, MD
Neurosurgeon & Board Member
Mission Hospital



Sridhar Yerramreddy
Founder & CEO
Steer Health





Watch now and see

- "How AI fixed surgery delays, boosted margins & freed staff time."
- "40% fewer cancellations. 60+ new patients monthly. Watch how."
- "AI that makes hospitals faster, smarter & more profitable."

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